Tula: UI/UX Design Spec

Personal health assistant. Version 1.0, 8 Oct 2026. Owner: Alok Kumar Mishra.
Tula should feel like a calm health notebook kept by a friend who happens to be a nutritionist. It should not feel like a dashboard or a chatbot skin. Every design decision in this document serves one product rule: the user gives about 10 seconds of input a day, and the app does the rest.

1. Design philosophy

1.1 Why AI-generated apps look the same

Reviewers recognise generated apps from a short list of defaults. Tula avoids every one of them:

- Purple-to-blue gradients, glassmorphism, glowing borders and neon accents
- Sparkle icons and "AI-powered" badges on every surface
- Every screen built as a grid of identical cards, each with an icon, a title and a number
- Emoji used as icons, centred hero text, and "Welcome back!" greetings
- Spacing, radius and font sizes that change from screen to screen because nothing comes from tokens
- Only the happy path designed: no empty, loading, error or offline states
- Chat as the main interface, so the product is really a prompt box
- Stock gradient illustrations of people doing yoga

1.2 Principles Tula follows instead

1. **One job per screen.** Each screen answers one question and has one primary action. Today answers "how am I doing, and what should I do next".
2. **Numbers big, words few.** The user should read the state of their day in under 2 seconds. Explanations are one line, with a tap for more.
3. **The AI stays invisible.** No sparkles and no "AI" labels. The intelligence shows up as good defaults, pre-filled forms and a nudge at the right moment.
4. **Editorial, not dashboard.** A serif display face paired with a clean sans, left-aligned text, clear hierarchy and some asymmetry. It should read like a well-set magazine page.
5. **Food-first and India-first.** The user's own meal photos, Indian portion words (katori, roti, plate, glass) and Indian meal times. Specific choices like these are the strongest signal that a person made decisions.
6. **Every state is designed.** Empty, loading, partial, error, offline and success exist for every screen before the screen is called done.
7. **Calm, never guilty.** Going over target is shown in warm amber, never alarm red, and the copy points to tomorrow instead of scolding today.

2. Visual identity

2.1 Colour

Light theme by default. One accent colour, used for the primary action and progress only. Status colours are muted so they read as information, not alarms.

Token	Hex	Used for
bg	#F7F4EE	App background (warm paper, not pure white)
surface	#FFFFFF	Cards and sheets
surfaceSunken	#EFEBE3	Input fields, empty slots, segmented control track
ink	#1E2420	Primary text
inkMuted	#6A706B	Secondary text, captions
inkFaint	#A3A79F	Placeholders, disabled
line	#E4DFD5	Dividers and hairline borders
accent	#2F6B4F	Primary buttons, ring fill, links (deep sage)
accentSoft	#DCEBE2	Selected chips, nudge card background
good	#4E9A6B	In range
warn	#D9962B	Slightly over, borderline marker
alert	#C2574A	Out-of-range lab values only
protein / carbs / fat / fiber	#5B7FB8 / #D9A441 / #C77D5E / #6E9B5A	Macro bars, always the same mapping

Rules: no gradients except one very soft radial wash behind the ring on Today. The accent never appears on more than two elements per screen. A dark theme can follow the system setting, but it is not the default.

2.2 Typography

Role	Font	Size / line height	Weight
Display (hero numbers, screen titles)	Fraunces (serif)	34 / 40	600
Title	Fraunces	24 / 30	600
Heading	Inter	17 / 24	600
Body	Inter	15 / 22	400
Caption	Inter	13 / 18	500
Numerals in data	Inter with tabular figures	inherits	600

The serif is the main thing that separates Tula from template apps. Use it only for display numbers and screen titles. Load only the weights listed, with expo-font, to keep the bundle small.

2.3 Spacing, radius and elevation

- Spacing scale on a 4 pt grid: 4, 8, 12, 16, 20, 24, 32, 48. Screen side padding is 20; gap between cards is 12.

- Radius: 8 for inputs and small chips, 16 for cards, 24 for sheet tops, full for pills and the add button.
- Elevation: one shadow token (y 2, blur 12, ink at 6 percent). Cards on the paper background rely on the white surface plus a hairline border; only sheets and the floating add button get the shadow.

2.4 Iconography and imagery

- One icon set: Phosphor or Lucide, regular weight, 22 px, stroke 1.5. No emoji as icons anywhere in the interface.
- Food imagery is the user's own photos, cropped to rounded squares. No stock food photography.
- Illustration is limited to three small line drawings in the accent colour: empty Today, empty Reports and the onboarding finale. A simple katori, a leaf and a lab tube work well and feel local.
- Tula has no avatar face. Its presence is a small sage leaf mark next to its messages.

3. Voice and micro-copy

Tula speaks like a friendly coach: short, specific, warm, and never preachy. Sentences stay under 12 words in the interface.

Situation	Avoid	Write
Morning greeting	Welcome back! Ready to crush your goals?	Morning, Alok. 1,850 kcal to play with today.
Over target	You exceeded your calorie limit!	About 200 over today. Tomorrow's a fresh ring.
Protein low at 4 pm	Remember to eat healthy!	40 g protein to go. Roasted chana or curd would do it.
AI failed	Something went wrong. Please try again.	Saved as text. I'll add the numbers in a minute.
Non-food photo	Invalid image.	That doesn't look like food. Try another shot?
Lab value high	Your LDL is dangerously high.	LDL is above range. More fibre helps; worth a chat with your doctor.

Rules: no exclamation marks except on milestones, numbers always with units, Indian English and Indian food names, and no medical diagnosis words.

4. Navigation and responsive behaviour

Mobile (under 768 px): three bottom tabs, Today, Reports and Tula (chat), with a floating round add button centred above the tab bar. The add button opens the Log sheet from any tab.
Desktop and web (768 px and above): a 220 px left sidebar holds the same three destinations and a full-width "Log a meal" button. Content sits in a centred column with a maximum width of 560 px; Today adds a right column for the week view when width allows.

Pattern	Mobile	Desktop
Log, confirm meal, edit item	Bottom sheet with drag handle, snaps at 60 and 92 percent	Centred modal, 480 px wide, closes on Esc
Marker detail	Push screen	Inline expand in the list
Destructive confirm	Action sheet	Small dialog
Feedback	Toast above the tab bar	Toast at bottom-left
Camera	Full-screen camera	File picker with drag and drop

Build one Sheet component that chooses its rendering from window width, so screens never branch on platform themselves.

5. Component kit

Build these before any screen. Every screen is assembled only from them, with values from the theme file.

Component	Variants and notes
Screen	Safe area, background, optional large serif title, pull to refresh
Card	Default, sunken, accent (nudge); optional left accent border
Button	Primary (filled accent), secondary (outline), ghost; sizes M and L; loading and disabled states; minimum height 48
Chip	Selectable, removable, status (good / warn / alert); used for meal type, portions and markers
PortionStepper	Half-step increments with unit label (katori, roti, piece, glass)
ProgressRing	Animated SVG arc, centre slot for remaining kcal, over-target state turns amber
MacroBar	Thin horizontal bar with label and grams; fixed colour per macro
MealRow	Thumbnail, meal type, item summary, kcal; swipe for edit and delete on mobile
RangeBar	Lab marker range with low, normal and high zones and a dot for the user's value
Sheet	Bottom sheet on mobile, modal on desktop (see section 4)
NudgeCard	Leaf mark, one line of copy, one action button, dismiss
EmptyState	Line illustration, one sentence, one action
Skeleton	Shimmer blocks matching each list and card shape
Toast	Success, info and error; optional Undo action
ChatBubble	User, Tula and rich (embedded meal card or marker card)
OfflineBanner	Thin sunken bar: "Offline. Logs will sync when you're back."

6. Screen-by-screen specification

6.1 Onboarding (5 steps)

Goal: collect enough to build a personal plan in under 60 seconds.

1. Welcome: serif line "Let's set up your plan. About a minute." and a Start button. No carousel of feature slides.
2. Goal: four large option cards, one tap each: Lose weight, Maintain, Build muscle, Improve a health marker.
3. Basics: name, age, sex, height and weight using wheel pickers and steppers. No keyboard except for name.
4. Activity: four cards with a plain description each ("Mostly sitting", "On my feet", "Exercise 3 to 4 days", "Very active").
5. Report (optional): "Have a recent blood report? I'll use it to personalise your plan." Upload or Skip for now.

Layout: thin progress bar at the top, back arrow, question in the serif title style, options below, primary button pinned to the bottom. Selecting an option auto-advances after 250 ms.
States: validation inline under the field (for example an age outside 15 to 90), report upload processing shown as a small inline progress, and progress saved locally so a killed app resumes at the same step.

6.2 Your Plan (onboarding finale)

This screen answers WHAT, WHY and HOW in one view.

- **WHAT:** hero number "1,850 kcal a day" in the display serif, with protein, fibre and water targets as pills underneath.
- **WHY:** a card with two or three sentences tied to the user's own data, for example "A 450 kcal daily gap gets you to 72 kg around 20 Jan. Your LDL is 152, so the fibre target matters more than calories for you."
- **Projection:** a small line from today's weight to the target date.
- **HOW:** "Just photograph your meals. I'll do the maths." with one button, "Log my first meal".

Delight: the hero number counts up from zero over 600 ms and the leaf illustration draws in.

6.3 Today (home)

Top to bottom:

1. Header: "Thursday, 8 Oct" in caption style, greeting in title serif, and a streak count with a small flame line icon on the right.
2. Ring card: large ring showing kcal remaining in the centre, three MacroBars below (protein, carbs, fat) and fibre as a fourth.
3. Nudge card: exactly one, chosen by time of day and the day's gaps, with one action.
4. Meals timeline: Breakfast, Lunch, Snacks and Dinner. Logged meals show as MealRows; unlogged ones as dashed sunken rows with "Add breakfast".
5. Markers strip: horizontal chips for flagged lab values, for example "LDL 152 high". Tapping opens the marker detail.
6. Week strip: seven dots for the last seven days, filled when the day was on target.

States:

- Day one: ring at full remaining, nudge "Photograph your first meal and I'll start learning your habits", timeline all dashed.
- Loading: skeletons for the ring card and meal rows.
- All meals logged and on target: nudge becomes a calm "Day complete" card.
- Over target: ring turns amber, centre reads "210 over", copy stays calm.
- Offline: OfflineBanner at the top; queued meals show a small clock icon.

6.4 Log sheet

- Three large tiles in a row: Camera, Voice, Type.
- Below them, "Quick add" chips for repeat meals: "Same breakfast as yesterday", plus the user's two most frequent meals.
- Meal type is pre-selected from the time of day and can be changed with a segmented control.

6.5 Capture and analysing

Camera: full-screen preview with a square crop guide, shutter, gallery button and flash toggle. Permission denied shows a sheet explaining why and a button to open settings, with "Type instead" as a fallback.
Voice: a large mic button that pulses with input volume, a live timer and "Listening. Say what you ate." Tap to stop; recordings stop automatically at 30 seconds.
Analysing: the photo thumbnail with a soft shimmer and rotating lines such as "Spotting the dal", "Counting rotis" and "Checking portions". No generic spinner. Timeout after 15 seconds offers "Save as text and finish later".

6.6 Confirm meal sheet (the most important screen)

- Header: photo thumbnail, meal type chip and time.
- Item list: each row has the food name, a PortionStepper with an Indian unit, and kcal aligned right. Swipe or tap the cross to remove; "Add item" at the end.
- Low-confidence items show a small "Not sure" chip. Tapping it asks one question with two or three answers, for example "Paneer or tofu?".
- Sticky footer: "This meal: 540 kcal, 22 g protein" and the primary button "Log meal".
- After logging: the sheet closes, the ring animates to its new value, a light haptic fires, and a toast shows one insight with Undo.

Edge states: not food, nothing recognised, more than eight items (collapse into groups), duplicate submit (button disabled while saving), and edits to a past meal (same sheet, "Save changes").

6.7 Reports

- Upload card at the top: "Add a lab report (PDF or photo)".
- Report list, newest first: lab or file name, date, and a count such as "3 to watch".
- Processing row while extraction runs, with the same shimmer treatment as meals.
- Errors: "This doesn't look like a lab report", "Couldn't read this clearly. Try a sharper photo", and "Already uploaded on 2 Sep".

- Empty state: line drawing of a lab tube and "Upload a blood report and I'll explain it in plain words."

6.8 Report and marker detail

- Markers grouped by status: To watch first, then In range (collapsed).
- Each marker card shows the name, value with unit, a RangeBar and a status chip.
- Expanded card: what the marker is (one line), why it matters for this user (one line), and "Your daily action", which links to the target it changed, for example "Fibre target raised to 30 g".
- Trend sparkline when the marker appears in more than one report.
- Footer in caption style: "For understanding only. Discuss results with your doctor."

6.9 Tula chat

- Empty state shows four suggestion chips: "How am I doing this week?", "What should I eat for dinner?", "Explain my report", "Log 2 idlis and chutney".
- Tula replies can embed rich cards: a meal card when it logs food, a marker card when it explains a value, and a mini ring when it summarises the day.
- Typing indicator is three dots in the leaf colour. Streaming text appears word by word.
- Rate-limited or offline: the message stays in the composer with a retry action, never silently lost.

7. Motion, haptics and delight

Moment	Motion	Haptic
Meal logged	Ring arc animates with a spring, 500 ms	Light impact
Daily target met	Ring completes, soft pulse once	Success notification
Streak milestone (3, 7, 14, 30 days)	Small confetti burst in brand colours, under 1 second	Success notification
Option selected in onboarding	Card scales to 0.98 and fills	Selection
Sheet open and close	Spring, damping 20	None
Hero numbers	Count up, 600 ms ease-out	None

Rules: motion confirms an action or shows progress, never decorates. Every animation respects the system "reduce motion" setting. Use Reanimated for all of it.
Motivation devices: a streak with one free rest day per week so a single miss does not reset it, a weekly recap card every Sunday evening, and small milestone moments. No points, coins or leaderboards; they don't suit a health product and add scope.

8. Accessibility

- Text contrast of at least 4.5:1 against its background; check inkMuted on bg and surfaceSunken.
- Touch targets of at least 44 by 44 pt; primary actions within thumb reach on mobile.
- Status is never shown by colour alone: every status chip has a word (High, Low, In

range).
- Dynamic type supported up to 130 percent without clipping; test the ring centre text.
- Screen-reader labels on the ring ("1,240 of 1,850 kilocalories eaten"), steppers and icon buttons.

9. Anti-AI-look checklist

Run this on every screen before calling it done.

- Does the screen have exactly one primary action?
- Is every colour, size and spacing value from the theme file, with no literal values in components?
- Is there any gradient, glow, sparkle icon or "AI" label? Remove it.
- Is there an emoji used as an icon? Replace it with a Phosphor or Lucide icon.
- Is the copy specific to the user (their number, their food, their marker), or could it appear in any app?
- Are empty, loading, error and offline states designed and reachable?
- Would the screen still make sense in black and white?
- Does the serif appear only on display numbers and titles?
- Is any text longer than two lines without a tap to expand?

10. References to study

- Cal AI: photo-to-meal logging flow and confirmation step
- Oura: calm home screen, one score with an explanation
- Apple Health and Fitness: rings and restraint with colour
- Headspace: warm voice and simple line illustration
- Mobbin search terms: "nutrition tracker", "meal log", "lab results", "health onboarding"

Take one specific idea from each reference and write down what it was. Do not copy any single app's layout.